

The Drawing Is Not the System

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DEEP DIVE · CASE 009

The connection that

changed its own load path

Hyatt Regency Walkways · Kansas City, USA · 1981

STRUCTURAL STEEL CONNECTIONS LOAD PATH DESIGN COORDINATION

On 17 July 1981, the suspended second- and fourth- THE ORIGINAL DETAIL

WAS ALREADY WEAK

floor walkways in the Hyatt Regency atrium

NBS estimated that a properly designed original connection

collapsed. 114 people were killed. The physical should have provided at

least about 33.9 kip (151 kN)

failure was devastating; the engineering lesson is ultimate capacity. The

actual original configuration averaged

unnervingly compact: a shop-detail change that roughly 20.5 kip (91 kN).

The as-built revised connection

looked minor altered which connection carried the was worse still: NBS

The Drawing Is Not the System

